



GERMANE MEDIA LLC - POLICY DOCUMENT

1. Leave Policy

Leave Policy for Full-Time Employees

- Full-time employees are entitled to **1.5 paid leaves per month**, amounting to **18 paid leaves in a year**.
- If you do not utilise your monthly leave entitlement, the unused leave will automatically be added to your leave balance and can be used at any time during your employment, subject to approval.
- Any leave taken beyond your available leave balance will be treated as **Leave Without Pay (LOP)**.

Example:

- If you have completed **2 months** of employment, you will have **3 leaves** in your leave balance.
- If you have completed **5 months** of employment, you will have **7.5 leaves** in your leave balance.
- If you take more leaves than your available leave balance, the additional leaves will be treated as **LOP**.

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Leave Policy for Interns

- Interns are entitled to **1 paid leave per month**.
- If a monthly leave is not utilised, it will be added to the intern's leave balance and may be used at any time during the internship, subject to approval.
- Any leave taken beyond the available leave balance will be treated as **LOP**.

Leave Policy for Employees Under Probation

- The probation period is **3 months**.
 - During the probation period, employees are entitled to **1 paid leave per month**.
 - Upon successful completion of probation, employees become eligible for **1.5 paid leaves per month**, in line with the Full-Time Employee Leave Policy.
 - The additional **0.5 leave per month** applicable after confirmation will be credited accordingly and may be utilised at any time, subject to approval.
 - Any leave taken beyond the available leave balance will be treated as **LOP**.
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Leave Policy for Consultants

- Consultants are **not entitled to paid leaves**.
 - Any absence from work will be treated as **Loss of Pay (LOP)** unless compensated through approved working hours.
 - Consultants may compensate for missed working days by working on weekends or public holidays, provided:
 - Prior approval is obtained from the Reporting Manager.
 - The compensatory working day is properly recorded and approved in **Zoho People**.
 - If attendance is not recorded or approved in Zoho, or if there is no valid punch-in for the respective day, it will be considered an absence and treated as **LOP**.
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Leave Calculation & Carry Forward Policy

- Leave entitlement is calculated from the employee's **date of joining** and follows a rolling **12-month cycle**.
 - Unused monthly leave will continue to accumulate in the employee's leave balance during the year.
 - Upon completion of one year of service, unused leaves will be carried forward to the next leave cycle as per the following rule:
 - **The lower of:**
 - Total unused leave balance, or
 - **30% of the annual leave entitlement** of the previous leave cycle.
 - This carry-forward policy is effective from the date of implementation of this policy. Leave balances from previous policy periods will not be considered for carry forward.
 - **Unused leave is not eligible for encashment.** No payment will be made in lieu of unutilised leave at any stage of employment unless otherwise required by applicable law.
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Important Reminders

- All leaves are subject to prior approval from the Reporting Manager unless it is an emergency.
- Employees are responsible for maintaining sufficient leave balance before applying for leave.
- Any leave taken beyond the available leave balance will be treated as **Leave Without Pay (LOP)**.
- **Example:** If you have completed **4 months**, your leave balance will be **6 leaves**. If you take **7 leaves**, **1 leave** will be treated as **LOP**.

2. Leave Application Process

Advance Notice

Employees are expected to plan their leave in advance wherever possible. The following notice period must be followed:

- **Urgent Leave:** If your leave is urgent (medical emergency or some serious issue), you must:
 - Submit your leave request through **Zoho People**, and
 - Inform your Reporting Manager via chat or any official communication channel,
 - **At least one day before** the leave date.
- **Planned Leave:** If you are aware of your leave in advance, you must submit your leave request according to the following timelines:
 - **1–2 days of leave:** At least **1 week** in advance.
 - **3 days of leave:** At least **2 weeks** in advance.
 - **5 days or more:** At least **1 month** in advance.
- Approval of leave is **entirely subject to your Reporting Manager's approval**. Submitting a leave request does not guarantee that it will be approved.

Medical Emergency Exception

The advance notice requirement does not apply in the case of a genuine medical emergency or hospitalization.

In such cases:

- You must inform your Reporting Manager and the HR through any official communication channel as soon as reasonably possible.
- The leave request may be submitted or regularised later on Zoho.
- Supporting medical documents may be requested before the leave is approved.

This exception applies **only** to medical emergencies.

Any non-medical leave request submitted without following the required notice period may be rejected and treated as **Leave Without Pay (LOP)**.

Example:

If you already know that you need leave to attend a wedding, family function, festival, vacation, examination, or any other planned event, you are expected to apply for leave within the timelines mentioned above. Applying only one or two days before such a planned event may result in the leave request being rejected.

Leave Approval

For Full-Time Employees

- All leave requests must be submitted through **Zoho People**.
- Leave will be considered approved **only after approval by your Reporting Manager** in Zoho.
- Any leave taken without prior approval will be treated as **Leave Without Pay (LOP)**.

For Interns

- Interns must submit their leave requests through **email** to their Reporting Manager, with HR copied wherever applicable.
- Leave will be considered approved only after receiving confirmation from the Reporting Manager.

Manager Approval

- Requesting leave does **not** guarantee approval.
 - Reporting Managers have the authority to approve or reject leave requests based on business requirements, workload, and team availability.
 - If a Reporting Manager has any doubts regarding a leave request or its eligibility under the policy, they must consult the HR team before approving or rejecting the request.
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Leave Without Pay (LOP) Policy

- Any leave request submitted **after 10:00 AM on the day of leave** will automatically be treated as **LOP**.
- The only exception is a genuine medical emergency or hospitalization, where timely communication and valid supporting documents are provided.

- Employees are expected to notify their Reporting Manager as early as possible in such situations.
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Valid Reason & Supporting Documents

- Every leave request must include a genuine and valid reason.
- The company reserves the right to request supporting documents whenever necessary.
- Depending on the nature of the leave, employees may be required to provide documents such as:
 - Medical certificates or doctor's prescriptions
 - Hospital admission or discharge documents
 - Travel tickets
 - Any other supporting document relevant to the leave request

Failure to provide the required documents may result in the leave request being rejected or treated as **LOP**.

Proper Communication

- Applying for leave is a **request**, not merely an intimation.
- Employees must obtain approval before proceeding on leave, except in genuine medical emergencies.
- Employees should not assume that a leave request has been approved until they receive confirmation from their Reporting Manager.
- Failure to follow the leave application process may result in the leave being treated as **Leave Without Pay (LOP)**.

3. Attendance Policy

Attendance & Punch-In Requirements

- All employees are required to record their attendance by punching **in and out through Zoho People** every working day.
- Failure to record attendance correctly may result in the day being treated as **Leave Without Pay (LOP)** unless a valid reason has been communicated and approved by the Reporting Manager and HR.
- Employees must ensure that their attendance records accurately reflect their actual working hours.

Mandatory Stand-up Meetings

- Attendance in both the **morning and evening stand-up meetings** is mandatory unless otherwise approved by the Reporting Manager.
 - Failure to attend either stand-up meeting without prior approval or a valid reason may result in the day being treated as **LOP**.
 - Reporting Managers are responsible for informing the HR team of any team member who fails to attend the mandatory stand-up meetings.
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Working Hours & Flexible Timings

The company follows **flexible working hours** to provide employees with reasonable flexibility. However, flexible timings should not be misused.

Flexible working hours **do not** mean that employees may:

- Punch in significantly later than their scheduled working hours.
- Extend their punch-out time late into the night merely to complete the required working hours.
- Regularly alter their working schedule without prior approval.

Employees are expected to maintain a consistent work schedule aligned with their team's official working hours.

Team Working Hours

Team	Working Hours
Ad Operations	10:00 AM – 7:00 PM
Content Acquisition	10:30 AM – 7:30 PM
Technology	10:00 AM – 7:00 PM
Sales	10:00 AM – 7:00 PM

Marketing	10:00 AM – 7:00 PM
Design	10:00 AM – 7:00 PM

All employees are expected to punch in according to their team's designated working hours.

Punch-In Flexibility

To support reasonable flexibility while maintaining discipline, employees are allowed a **15-minute grace window** around their team's scheduled start time.

- Employees may punch in **up to 15 minutes before** or **up to 15 minutes after** their designated reporting time without any issue.
- Punching in **more than 15 minutes early** or **more than 15 minutes late** on a regular basis is **not permitted**.
- Any deviation beyond the 15-minute grace window must have prior approval from the Reporting Manager or a valid business justification.
- Repeated violations of the prescribed punch-in timings without prior approval may be treated as an attendance irregularity and may result in disciplinary action, including **Leave Without Pay (LOP)** or other monetary deductions as per company policy.

Examples:

- **Team timing: 10:00 AM**
 - Acceptable punch-in: **9:45 AM to 10:15 AM**
 - Not acceptable without approval: **Before 9:45 AM** or **After 10:15 AM**
- **Team timing: 10:30 AM**
 - Acceptable punch-in: **10:15 AM to 10:45 AM**
 - Not acceptable without approval: **Before 10:15 AM** or **After 10:45 AM**

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Early Punch-In & Early Punch-Out

- Regularly punching in before your scheduled working hours is **not permitted**.
 - Early punch-ins are allowed only when there is a genuine business requirement or urgent work and must be approved by your Reporting Manager.
 - Employees are **not permitted to punch out before their scheduled working hours** without prior approval.
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Daily Working Hours

- Employees are required to complete **9 hours** each working day, including a **1-hour lunch break**.
 - Employees are expected to remain available during their scheduled working hours unless they have received prior approval for any deviation.
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Attendance Monitoring

The HR team will share **monthly attendance reports** with Reporting Managers.

Attendance reports will be reviewed for:

- Late punch-ins.
- Early punch-outs.
- Missed punch-ins or punch-outs.
- Irregular working patterns.
- Frequent deviations from scheduled working hours.
- Absence from mandatory stand-up meetings.

Employees are expected to maintain regular attendance and adhere to the company's attendance requirements.

Where repeated attendance irregularities are identified without prior approval or a valid justification, the company reserves the right to take appropriate disciplinary action, including **monetary deductions**, **Leave Without Pay (LOP)**, or other disciplinary measures as deemed appropriate by the management.

4. Full & Final Settlement (FNF)

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Full & Final Settlement Timeline

- The **Full & Final Settlement (FNF)** will be processed **30 calendar days after the employee's Last Working Day (LWD)**, subject to successful completion of all exit formalities.
- The FNF amount will include all eligible salary after adjusting any recoveries, deductions, or pending liabilities.

Examples:

Example 1 – 30-Day Notice Period

- Resignation Date: **20 July**
- Last Working Day: **20 August**
- FNF Processing Date: **20 September**

The employee will receive:

- Salary for the days worked in **July**.
- Salary for the days worked in **August** up to the Last Working Day.
- Any other eligible dues after applicable adjustments.

Example 2 – 60-Day Notice Period

- Resignation Date: **20 July**
- Last Working Day: **20 September**
- FNF Processing Date: **20 October**

The employee will receive:

- Salary for the days worked in **August**.
- Salary for the days worked in **September** up to the Last Working Day.
- Any other eligible dues after applicable adjustments.

Handover of Responsibilities

- Employees are required to complete a proper handover of all ongoing work, responsibilities, passwords (where applicable), documents, knowledge, and project-related information to their Reporting Manager or the designated employee before their Last Working Day.
- Failure to complete the handover satisfactorily may result in a delay in the Full & Final Settlement and the issuance of the relieving documents.

Return of Company Assets

- All company assets must be returned on or before the Last Working Day.
- Company assets may include, but are not limited to:
 - Laptop, desktop, mobile devices, or accessories
 - Any other equipment or property issued by the company

The **Full & Final Settlement (FNF)** will be processed only after all company assets and documents have been returned and verified by the company.

Salary Slips & Employment Documents

- Employees are advised to download and securely retain all salary slips and other employment-related records before their official company email or system access is deactivated.
 - The company will **not reissue or resend salary slips or other documents** that were already shared with the employee prior to the deactivation of their official email or access.
 - It is the employee's responsibility to maintain copies of these documents for future reference.
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Experience Letter & Relieving Letter

- The **Experience Letter** and **Relieving Letter** will be issued **only on or after the employee's Last Working Day**, provided all exit formalities have been completed.
 - The company reserves the right to withhold these documents until:
 - The employee has completed the required notice period (or fulfilled any applicable buyout obligations).
 - All company assets and documents have been returned.
 - The work handover has been completed to the satisfaction of the Reporting Manager.
 - Any other exit formalities prescribed by the company have been successfully completed.
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Reimbursement Policy After Resignation

- Once an employee submits their resignation, **no reimbursement claims will be accepted or processed**, irrespective of when the expense was incurred.
- Employees are expected to submit all eligible reimbursement claims **before submitting their resignation**.
- Any reimbursement claim submitted after the resignation date, including claims for expenses incurred in previous months, will not be processed or paid.
- The Full & Final Settlement (FNF) will include only the employee's eligible salary and other applicable dues, subject to company policy. **No pending or new reimbursement claims will be included after the resignation date.**

Example:

If an employee submits their resignation on **20 July** and subsequently submits reimbursement claims in July for expenses incurred during the previous three months, those reimbursement claims will **not** be processed. The employee will only receive the salary and other eligible dues payable up to their Last Working Day, subject to the terms of the FNF policy.

5. Reimbursement Policy

Eligibility

- The reimbursement policy is applicable **only to Full-Time Employees and Interns**.
- **Consultants are not eligible** for any reimbursements unless specifically approved by the management.

General Reimbursement Guidelines

- Employees may submit reimbursement claims **only for expenses incurred within the previous three months**.
- Any reimbursement claim older than **three months** from the date of submission will not be considered.
- Reimbursement claims must be submitted **on or before the 22nd of the month**.
- Any reimbursement request submitted **after the 22nd of the month** will be processed in the next reimbursement cycle only if it falls within the eligible three-month period. Claims that exceed the three-month eligibility window will not be accepted.
- Reimbursements are processed **once every three months**. Employees should therefore submit all eligible bills together once their previous reimbursement cycle has been completed.
- Employees are responsible for maintaining copies of all invoices and supporting documents until the reimbursement has been successfully processed.

Submission Process

To claim reimbursement, employees must:

1. Collect and retain all original bills, invoices, or payment receipts.
2. Submit the reimbursement request along with all supporting documents through email

3. After submitting the bills, send a reminder to the HR team via **Google Chat (personal chat)** between the **22nd and 25th of the month** to ensure the request is reviewed.

Please note:

- The HR will **not send monthly reminders** requesting employees to submit reimbursement bills.
- It is solely the employee's responsibility to submit reimbursement claims on time and follow up within the prescribed timeline.

Employee Wellness Reimbursement

The company encourages employees to maintain a healthy lifestyle and supports physical well-being through its Employee Wellness Initiative.

Eligible expenses include, but are not limited to:

- Gym memberships
- Yoga classes
- Fitness training
- Sports or physical activity programmes
- Any other approved physical wellness activity

Reimbursement Limit

- Employees are eligible for reimbursement of **up to ₹1,000 per month**.
- If the actual eligible expense is **less than ₹1,000**, only the actual amount paid will be reimbursed.
- Reimbursement is subject to the submission of valid bills and receipts.

How to Claim:

1. Participate in any eligible wellness activity.
2. Retain all invoices or payment receipts.
3. Submit your bills once every three months following the reimbursement submission process.

Internet (Wi-Fi) Reimbursement

The same reimbursement process and timelines apply to **Wi-Fi reimbursement**.

Employees claiming Wi-Fi reimbursement must:

- Submit valid monthly internet bills.
 - Submit claims once every three months.
 - Ensure the bills are submitted before the **22nd of the month**.
 - Send a reminder to HR via **Google Chat** between the **22nd and 25th** after submitting the bills.
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Important Points

- Reimbursements are processed only after verification of the submitted documents.
- Incomplete submissions or missing supporting documents may delay or result in rejection of the reimbursement request.
- Employees who have submitted their resignation are **not eligible to claim or receive any reimbursements** after the date of resignation, irrespective of when the expense was incurred.
- The company reserves the right to reject any reimbursement request that does not comply with this policy.

7. Employee Tracking & Productivity Policy

Working Hours & Productivity

- Employees are required to punch in and punch out through **Zoho People** every working day.
 - During working hours, employees are expected to remain actively engaged in productive work and be available for business-related communication.
 - Excessive idle time or prolonged unavailability during working hours should be avoided unless it has been approved by the Reporting Manager.
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Response Time

- Employees are expected to acknowledge work-related messages from their **Reporting Manager, HR team, or colleagues within 1 hour** during official working hours.
- An acknowledgement may simply confirm that the message has been received and indicate when a detailed response will be provided.

- This policy is intended to ensure smooth communication and efficient collaboration across teams.
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Inactivity During Working Hours

- Employees are expected to remain available and responsive throughout their scheduled working hours, excluding approved breaks.
 - If an employee is found to be **inactive for more than one continuous hour** during working hours without prior approval or a valid reason (excluding the designated lunch break), the period may be treated as an attendance irregularity.
 - Repeated or unexplained inactivity may result in **Leave Without Pay (LOP)**, monetary deductions, or other disciplinary action, as determined by the management.
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Escalation Process

- If an employee does not receive an acknowledgement or response from a colleague within **1 hour** during working hours and the matter is work-related, they should:
 1. Send a follow-up message to the concerned employee.
 2. If there is still no response, inform their **Reporting Manager** and the **HR team** for appropriate action.

This process helps ensure timely communication, accountability, and uninterrupted workflow across the organisation.

8. Appraisal Policy

Appraisal Eligibility

- Employees become eligible for a performance appraisal upon completing **12 months of continuous service** from their date of joining.
 - The appraisal process is based on the employee's performance, contribution, business requirements, and management's discretion.
 - Completion of 12 months of service makes an employee **eligible for appraisal consideration** and does **not** guarantee a salary revision.
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Early Appraisal

- In exceptional cases, the management may grant an appraisal before the completion of 12 months if it believes that an employee's performance, responsibilities, or compensation warrants an earlier salary revision.
 - Any early appraisal is solely at the discretion of the management and should not be considered a standard practice.
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Appraisal Decision

- The percentage or amount of the appraisal will be determined solely by the management after considering:
 - Individual performance.
 - Contribution to the organisation.
 - Role and responsibilities.
 - Business performance and organisational requirements.
 - Internal salary structure and market benchmarks, where applicable.
 - The management's decision regarding the appraisal amount shall be final.
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Appraisal Discussion

- If an employee has any questions or concerns regarding their appraisal, they should first discuss the matter with their **Reporting Manager**.
 - Employees should not directly approach senior management regarding appraisal-related concerns unless specifically advised to do so by their Reporting Manager or HR.
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Appraisal Timeline

- Appraisal discussions and annual performance feedback meetings are conducted **only during the last week of the relevant month**.
- Employees who complete their appraisal eligibility during a month will have their appraisal discussion scheduled during the **last week of that same month**.

Example:

- If an employee completes **1 year of service on 5 July**, their annual performance review and appraisal discussion will be conducted during the **last week of July**.
- Subject to management approval, any revised compensation will become effective as communicated in the appraisal letter.

General Conditions

- An appraisal is based on overall performance and organisational requirements and is **not an automatic annual increment**.
- The company reserves the right to defer, revise, or withhold an appraisal based on business requirements, employee performance, disciplinary concerns, or any other factors deemed relevant by the management.

9. Employee Loan Policy

Purpose

The company may provide financial assistance to employees through an employee loan in cases of genuine **medical emergencies** or other **exceptional personal emergencies**, subject to management approval.

The granting of a loan is **not an employee entitlement** and will be considered on a case-by-case basis.

Eligibility

- Employee loans are available only for **medical emergencies** or other **genuine emergency situations** approved by the management.
- Approval of the loan is entirely at the discretion of the management.
- The company reserves the right to approve or reject any loan request without obligation to provide a reason.

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Loan Amount

- The maximum loan amount that may be sanctioned is **up to six (6) times the employee's monthly Basic Pay**.
- For the purpose of this policy, **Basic Pay** is defined as **50% of the employee's monthly gross salary**.

Example:

- Monthly Salary: ₹100,000
 - Basic Pay (50%): ₹50,000
 - Maximum Loan Eligibility: ₹300,000
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Loan Repayment

- The sanctioned loan must be repaid within a maximum period of **12 months**.
 - The repayment amount will be deducted directly from the employee's monthly salary.
 - The monthly repayment instalment shall be **at least 25% of the employee's monthly salary**, unless otherwise approved by the management.
 - Employees may choose to repay the loan earlier without any prepayment charges.
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Minimum Service Commitment

- Employees who avail a company loan are required to continue their employment with the company for a **minimum period of 12 months** from the date the loan is disbursed.
 - If an employee resigns or their employment is terminated before completing this period, the company reserves the right to recover the entire outstanding loan amount from:
 - The employee's Full & Final Settlement (FNF).
 - Any other amounts payable by the company.
 - If the outstanding loan amount exceeds the employee's FNF dues, the employee shall remain liable to repay the remaining balance immediately or as agreed with the company.
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Loan Agreement

- Employees must sign the company's **Loan Agreement** before any loan amount is disbursed.
 - The agreement will specify:
 - Loan amount.
 - Repayment schedule.
 - Monthly deduction amount.
 - Terms and conditions.
 - Recovery provisions in case of resignation or termination.
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General Conditions

- A loan will be disbursed only after receiving all required approvals and completion of the necessary documentation.
- Submission of a loan request does not guarantee approval.
- The company reserves the right to modify, suspend, or discontinue the Employee Loan Policy at any time without prior notice.

10. Training & Development Policy

Purpose

The company encourages continuous learning and professional development. To support employees in enhancing their knowledge and skills, the company provides reimbursement for approved learning and development programmes.

Reimbursement Limit

- The company will reimburse **up to ₹1,000 per month** towards eligible skill development courses.
- If the cost of a course exceeds ₹1,000 per month, the employee will be responsible for paying the remaining amount.

Example:

- Course Fee: **₹1,200**
- Company Reimbursement: **₹1,000**
- Employee Contribution: **₹200**

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Eligible Courses

Employees may apply for reimbursement for courses that are directly related to their role or contribute to their professional development, including but not limited to:

- Technical or software courses
- Professional certifications
- Marketing or sales programmes
- Design and creative learning
- Leadership and management courses
- Communication and soft skills

- Any other course approved by the management

The company reserves the right to determine whether a course qualifies for reimbursement.

Approval Process

- Employees must obtain **prior approval** from their Reporting Manager **before enrolling** in any course.
 - Reporting Managers must review the relevance of the course and share the proposed training details with the management for final approval.
 - Reimbursement will be provided only for courses that have received prior approval.
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Reimbursement Process

- Employees must retain all invoices, payment receipts, and completion records (where applicable).
 - Reimbursement claims will be processed **once every three months**.
 - Claims must be submitted in accordance with the company's Reimbursement Policy and within the prescribed timelines.
 - The company may request proof of course enrolment or completion before processing the reimbursement.
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Important Conditions

- Prior approval is mandatory. Courses enrolled in without approval may not be eligible for reimbursement.
 - Reimbursement is limited to the approved amount and is subject to verification of supporting documents.
 - Employees who have submitted their resignation will not be eligible to claim any training and development reimbursement after the resignation date.
 - The company reserves the right to approve, reject, modify, or discontinue this benefit at its sole discretion.
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11. Performance & Termination Policy

Probation Period

- The standard probation period for new employees is **three (3) months**, unless otherwise specified in the employment agreement.
 - During the probation period, the company will assess the employee's performance, conduct, attendance, work quality, and overall suitability for the role.
 - If an employee's performance is found to be unsatisfactory during probation, the company may:
 - Extend the probation period for a specified duration; or
 - Terminate the employment with immediate effect or with such notice as deemed appropriate by the management, in accordance with applicable law and the employment agreement.
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Performance Improvement Plan (PIP)

- If an employee's performance falls below the expected standards after confirmation of employment, the company may place the employee on a **Performance Improvement Plan (PIP)**.
 - The PIP will outline:
 - Performance concerns.
 - Expected improvements.
 - Performance goals.
 - Review period.
 - During the PIP period, the employee's performance will be closely monitored.
 - If the required improvement is not achieved within the stipulated period, the company may terminate the employee's employment. The management will determine the employee's Last Working Day in accordance with the employment agreement and applicable law.
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Resignation & Last Working Day

- Employees are required to serve the notice period mentioned in their employment agreement unless otherwise approved by the management.
- Upon submission of a resignation, the company reserves the right to determine the employee's **Last Working Day** based on business requirements, work handover, project dependencies, and replacement planning.
- Accordingly, the management may:
 - Relieve the employee before completion of the notice period;
 - Require the employee to serve the full notice period; or
 - Approve any other mutually agreed arrangement, subject to the terms of the employment agreement.

Unsatisfactory Performance & Disciplinary Action

- Employees are expected to maintain the performance, conduct, and behavioural standards prescribed by the company.
 - Where an employee consistently underperforms, repeatedly fails to meet expectations, or continues to violate company policies despite receiving counselling, feedback, or written warnings, the company may initiate disciplinary action.
 - Depending on the nature and severity of the issue, the company reserves the right to:
 - Issue verbal or written warnings.
 - Extend the probation period (where applicable).
 - Place the employee on a Performance Improvement Plan (PIP).
 - Take disciplinary action, including termination of employment, in accordance with the employment agreement and applicable law.
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Management's Discretion

- Decisions relating to probation, performance evaluation, disciplinary action, notice period, Last Working Day, and termination shall be made by the management after considering the employee's overall performance, business requirements, policy compliance, and organisational needs.
- The management's decision in such matters shall be final, subject to applicable laws.

12. Employee Referral Bonus Program

Purpose

The Employee Referral Bonus Program is designed to encourage employees to refer qualified and talented candidates to join **Germane Media LLC**. Employees whose referrals result in successful hires will be eligible for a referral bonus, subject to the terms and conditions of this policy.

Referral Bonus Structure

Referred Candidate Category	Referral Bonus
Intern	₹10,000
Full-Time Employee (0–4 years of experience)	₹25,000
Full-Time Employee (More than 4 years of experience)	₹50,000

Bonus Payment Conditions

The referral bonus will be paid only after the referred candidate successfully completes the required employment period:

- **Interns:** The referral bonus of **₹10,000** will be paid after the referred intern successfully completes the internship.
- **Full-Time Employees (0–4 years of experience):** The referral bonus of **₹25,000** will be paid after the referred employee successfully completes the probation period.
- **Full-Time Employees (More than 4 years of experience):** The referral bonus of **₹50,000** will be paid after the referred employee successfully completes the probation period.

General Terms & Conditions

- The referred candidate must clearly mention the referring employee's name during the recruitment process or before the first interview.
- Referral claims made after the candidate has already entered the recruitment process will not be considered.
- The referred candidate must successfully join the company and complete the applicable internship or probation period to qualify for the referral bonus.
- If the referred candidate resigns, abandons employment, or is terminated before successfully completing the applicable internship or probation period, **no referral bonus will be payable**.
- If multiple employees refer to the same candidate, the referral bonus will be awarded only to the employee whose referral was received first, as determined by the HR team.

- The referral bonus will be processed in the payroll following the candidate's successful completion of the applicable eligibility period.
- Any applicable taxes or statutory deductions will be deducted as per law.
- The management reserves the right to modify, suspend, or discontinue the Referral Bonus Program at any time without prior notice.
- In case of any dispute regarding referral eligibility or bonus payment, the decision of the management shall be final.

13. Probation Period / Completion of Internship

Probation Completion

- Employees approaching the end of their probation period are responsible for checking with their **Reporting Manager** and the **HR team** regarding the outcome of their probation.
 - This discussion should take place **10 to 15 days before** the scheduled end of the probation period. Requests made significantly earlier or after the probation end date may not be entertained.
 - The purpose of this discussion is to understand whether:
 - The employee's probation will be successfully completed.
 - The probation period will be extended.
 - Any further action is required based on the employee's performance.
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Internship Completion

- Interns approaching the end of their internship are responsible for checking with their **Reporting Manager** and the **HR team** regarding their internship status.
 - This discussion should take place **10 to 15 days before** the scheduled completion of the internship.
 - During this discussion, the intern will be informed whether:
 - The internship has been successfully completed.
 - The internship period will be extended.
 - The intern will be offered a Full-Time Employment opportunity, subject to business requirements and performance.
 - The internship will conclude without a full-time offer.
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Management Discretion

- The decision to:
 - Confirm an employee after probation,
 - Extend the probation period,
 - Confirm an intern for Full-Time Employment,
 - Extend the internship period, or
 - Conclude employment or the internship upon completion,
- shall be based on the employee's or intern's performance, business requirements, organisational needs, and management's evaluation.
- Completion of the probation period or internship **does not automatically guarantee confirmation of employment, conversion to a full-time role, or continued engagement** with the company.
- The final decision regarding probation confirmation, internship extension, full-time conversion, or separation shall rest solely with the management.

14. Company Laptop & Asset Usage Policy

The company provides laptops and other equipment to employees to enable them to perform their duties efficiently. All company-issued assets remain the property of **Germane Media LLC** and must be handled responsibly at all times.

Proper Usage & Care

Employees are expected to use company assets responsibly and ensure they remain in good working condition.

Employees must:

- Use company laptops and other assets only for authorised work-related purposes.
 - Avoid visiting unknown, suspicious, or potentially unsafe websites.
 - Do not open phishing, malicious, or unverified links received through emails, messages, or any other communication platform.
 - Do not download or install any unauthorised software, applications, browser extensions, or utilities without prior approval from the Technology Team or management.
 - Handle laptops and other company assets with due care and take all reasonable precautions to prevent physical damage, theft, or loss.
 - Ensure that laptop chargers, adapters, bags, and any other accessories issued by the company are properly maintained and kept in good condition.
-

Reporting Issues

- If a company laptop or any other company asset develops a technical issue, malfunction, is lost, stolen, or damaged, the employee must **immediately inform both the Reporting Manager and the HR team** through an official communication channel.
 - The company will make reasonable efforts to arrange repair or replacement support, including doorstep repair services where feasible, to minimise disruption to work.
-

Delay in Reporting

- Employees are required to report any issue, damage, malfunction, theft, or loss **immediately upon becoming aware of it**.
 - Any unreasonable delay in reporting such incidents may be treated as negligence and may result in disciplinary action or recovery of repair or replacement costs, where applicable.
-

General Responsibility

Employees are responsible for safeguarding all company-issued assets during their employment. Any misuse, negligence, unauthorised modification, or intentional damage to company property may result in disciplinary action and recovery of associated costs, in accordance with company policy.

15. Communication & Escalation Policy

To ensure smooth communication, faster resolution of concerns, and a clear reporting structure, all employees are expected to follow the communication hierarchy established by **Germane Media LLC**.

Communication Hierarchy

- Employees should communicate all work-related concerns, requests, approvals, feedback, or operational issues to their **Reporting Manager** in the first instance.
 - Routine operational matters, day-to-day discussions, and minor concerns should **not** be escalated directly to senior management.
-

Escalation Process

If an employee has any concern or issue, the following escalation process must be followed:

1. Discuss the matter with your **Reporting Manager**.
 2. If the concern involves your Reporting Manager or remains unresolved, contact the **HR team**.
 3. If the issue is still unresolved after discussion with both your Reporting Manager and HR, you may request a meeting with **Abhishek** through the appropriate channel.
-

Compliance

This communication structure has been established to ensure efficient decision-making, accountability, and effective management across the organisation. All employees are expected to adhere to this policy.

16. Reporting Manager Roles & Responsibilities

Reporting Managers play a critical role in ensuring the smooth functioning of their teams, maintaining productivity, and supporting employees in achieving both individual and organisational goals.

The following responsibilities are expected from every Reporting Manager at **Germane Media LLC**.

1. Leave Management

- Review and approve or reject leave requests submitted by team members in accordance with the company's Leave Policy.
 - Ensure leave approvals are based on business requirements, team availability, and workload.
 - Clarify any policy-related doubts with the HR team before approving or rejecting leave requests.
 - Ensure that all leave requests are processed through the prescribed approval channels.
-

2. Daily Team Updates

- Collect **End-of-Day (EOD)** updates from all team members on each working day.
 - Review completed work, ongoing tasks, blockers, and priorities for the following day.
 - Escalate critical issues or delays to the management whenever necessary.
-

3. Team Meetings

- Conduct regular team meetings, stand-up meetings, one-on-one discussions, or project review meetings whenever required.
 - Ensure meetings are focused, productive, and contribute to effective planning, communication, and execution.
 - Maintain clear communication regarding team objectives, deadlines, and expectations.
-

4. Task Allocation & Performance Monitoring

Reporting Managers are responsible for:

- Assigning work and setting clear expectations.
 - Monitoring the progress of assigned tasks.
 - Ensuring tasks are completed within the agreed timelines.
 - Identifying delays, risks, or blockers and taking corrective action promptly.
 - Providing regular guidance and support to team members.
 - Maintaining accountability and ensuring high standards of work quality.
-

5. Attendance & Productivity Monitoring

Reporting Managers are expected to:

- Monitor the attendance and punctuality of their team members.
 - Ensure employees attend mandatory meetings, including morning and evening stand-up calls.
 - Inform the HR team of any attendance irregularities, prolonged inactivity, policy violations, or repeated non-compliance.
 - Encourage discipline while maintaining a supportive work environment.
-

6. Reporting Structure

- Reporting Managers are required to report directly to **Abhishek** regarding team performance, operational updates, project progress, escalations, and other business matters.
 - Managers should ensure that communication follows the company's approved reporting hierarchy.
-

7. Employee Feedback & Performance Reviews

- Provide regular performance feedback to team members throughout the year.
 - Conduct periodic one-on-one discussions to support employee development.
 - Share performance observations, achievements, and areas for improvement with HR whenever required.
 - Submit formal feedback during quarterly or annual performance review cycles as requested by the company.
-

8. Policy Compliance

Reporting Managers are responsible for ensuring that team members comply with all company policies, including but not limited to:

- Attendance Policy
 - Leave Policy
 - Working Hours Policy
 - Communication & Escalation Policy
 - Information Security & Asset Usage Policy
 - Performance Standards
-

Managers should address policy violations promptly and escalate repeated or serious concerns to the HR team.

9. Leadership & Team Development

Reporting Managers are expected to:

- Foster a positive, respectful, and collaborative work environment.
- Mentor and guide team members in their professional growth.

- Encourage continuous learning and skill development.
 - Recognise good performance and provide constructive feedback where improvement is required.
 - Promote teamwork, accountability, and ownership within their teams.
-

10. General Responsibility

Reporting Managers are entrusted with the responsibility of leading their teams effectively while balancing employee well-being with business objectives. They are expected to exercise their authority fairly, maintain confidentiality where required, and act in the best interests of both the organisation and their team members.

Managers who fail to discharge their responsibilities or repeatedly neglect their managerial duties may be subject to appropriate corrective or disciplinary action as determined by the management.

17. Bank Account & Salary Transfer Policy

Employee Responsibility

- Employees are solely responsible for ensuring that the bank account details provided to the company are accurate, complete, and active for salary processing.
 - If there is any change in the employee's bank account details, or if the existing bank account becomes inactive, blocked, frozen, closed, or otherwise unable to receive payments, the employee must inform the HR and Finance team **before the salary processing date** and provide the updated bank details.
-

PSYCHOLOGY OF ADVERTISING

Incorrect Bank Details

- If an employee provides incorrect, incomplete, or invalid bank account details, the company shall not be responsible for any delay, failed transaction, or other issues arising from such incorrect information.
 - Any bank charges, penalties, or processing delays resulting from incorrect or outdated bank details shall be the responsibility of the employee, wherever applicable.
-

Salary Transfer

- The company's responsibility is fulfilled once the salary has been successfully processed and transferred to the bank account details provided by the employee.
 - If the salary amount has been successfully debited from the company's bank account but is delayed, rejected, or cannot be credited due to incorrect bank details, a blocked or inactive account, or any issue attributable to the employee or their bank, the company shall not be held responsible for such delays or consequences.
 - The company will, however, provide reasonable assistance by sharing transaction details or payment proof, if required, to help the employee coordinate with their bank.
-

Important Reminder

Employees are advised to verify their bank account details before every salary cycle and immediately notify the HR and Finance team of any changes. Failure to do so may result in delays in salary credit, for which the company shall not be held liable.

18. Variable Pay Policy

Purpose

Variable Pay is a performance-based component of compensation awarded at the sole discretion of the management. It is intended to recognise and reward employees based on their overall contribution, performance, and business outcomes.

Eligibility

- Payment of Variable Pay is **not guaranteed** and should not be considered a fixed component of an employee's salary.
 - Eligibility for Variable Pay does not automatically entitle an employee to receive any specific amount.
-

Determination of Variable Pay

- The amount of Variable Pay will be determined solely by the management after evaluating the employee's:
 - Overall performance.
 - Achievement of goals and responsibilities.

- Quality of work.
 - Productivity and contribution to the organisation.
 - Compliance with company policies and professional conduct.
 - Business performance and any other factors considered relevant by the management.
 - The management reserves the right to increase, reduce, or withhold Variable Pay based on its assessment.
-

Management Decision

- The amount of Variable Pay awarded to an employee is at the **sole discretion of the management**.
 - The management's decision regarding the Variable Pay amount shall be **final and binding** and will not be subject to review or revision.
-

Communication of Variable Pay

- Variable Pay details will be communicated through the employee's **salary slip** or other official payroll documents.
 - The company will **not communicate Variable Pay amounts through personal chats, messaging applications, or informal communication channels**.
-

Queries Regarding Variable Pay

- If an employee believes that Variable Pay was expected for a particular salary cycle but has not been reflected in their salary slip, they should contact the **HR team** for clarification.
 - Employees should not assume that Variable Pay is payable every month.
-

Zero Variable Pay

- Depending on the employee's performance, policy compliance, attendance, disciplinary record, or business considerations, the management may decide to award **zero Variable Pay** for a particular salary cycle.

- A decision to award zero Variable Pay shall not be treated as a payroll error and does not create any entitlement to future Variable Pay.
-

General Conditions

- Variable Pay forms part of the company's performance-based reward system and may be revised, modified, suspended, or discontinued by the management at any time.
- Nothing in this policy shall be interpreted as creating a contractual right or guaranteed entitlement to Variable Pay.

19. General Policies & Legal Provisions

Definitions

For the purpose of this Employee Policy Handbook:

- **Company** refers to **Germane Media LLC**.
- **Management** refers to the Founders, Directors, or any person authorised by the company to make employment-related decisions.
- **Reporting Manager** refers to the employee's immediate supervisor or any person officially assigned to manage the employee's work.
- **HR Team** refers to the Human Resources department or the authorised HR representative.
- **Working Day** means a scheduled business day of the company and excludes weekly offs and company-declared holidays unless otherwise specified.
- **LOP (Leave Without Pay)** means any period of absence that is not covered under an employee's available leave balance or is otherwise treated as unpaid leave under company policy.

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20. Code of Conduct

Every employee is expected to:

- Maintain honesty, integrity, and professionalism at all times.
- Treat colleagues, clients, vendors, and business partners with dignity and respect.
- Maintain a professional working environment free from harassment, discrimination, bullying, intimidation, or abusive behaviour.
- Perform assigned duties diligently and responsibly.

- Follow all company policies, processes, and instructions issued by management from time to time.
- Protect the reputation, confidential information, and interests of the company.

Any behaviour that adversely affects the company's reputation or working environment may result in disciplinary action.

21. Confidentiality & Information Security

Employees may have access to confidential business information during the course of their employment.

Confidential information includes, but is not limited to:

- Client information.
- Employee information.
- Financial records.
- Business strategies.
- Pricing information.
- Software, source code, and technical documentation.
- Internal communications.
- Vendor agreements.
- Any non-public company information.

Employees shall:

- Keep all confidential information strictly confidential.
- Not disclose confidential information to any third party without written authorisation.
- Use confidential information only for official company purposes.
- Return all confidential documents and company information upon separation from the company.

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The confidentiality obligation continues even after the employee leaves the organisation.

22. Company Data & IT Security

Employees must:

- Use company systems, email accounts, and devices responsibly.
- Create strong passwords and never share passwords with anyone.

- Immediately report any suspected data breach, phishing attempt, or cybersecurity incident.
- Not copy company files onto personal devices without approval.
- Not store confidential company information on unauthorised cloud storage platforms.
- Follow all cybersecurity instructions issued by the company.

Any unauthorised use or disclosure of company information may result in disciplinary action.

23. Anti-Harassment & Equal Opportunity

Germane Media LLC is committed to providing a respectful, inclusive, and professional workplace.

The company does not tolerate:

- Harassment.
- Sexual harassment.
- Bullying.
- Discrimination based on gender, religion, caste, disability, race, age, nationality, or any other protected characteristic.
- Threatening or abusive behaviour.

Any employee experiencing or witnessing such behaviour should immediately report the matter to their Reporting Manager or the HR team.

All complaints will be handled confidentially to the extent reasonably possible.

24. Conflict of Interest

Employees must avoid situations where their personal interests conflict with the interests of the company.

Employees shall not:

- Work for competitors without written approval.
- Engage in activities that adversely affect their responsibilities towards the company.
- Misuse company resources for personal gain.
- Accept gifts or benefits that may influence business decisions without prior approval.

Employees must disclose any actual or potential conflict of interest to the HR team or Management.

25. Disciplinary Action

Violation of company policies may result in disciplinary action.

Depending on the nature and seriousness of the violation, the company may take one or more of the following actions:

- Verbal warning.
- Written warning.
- Performance counselling.
- Performance Improvement Plan (PIP).
- Monetary deductions where permitted under company policy.
- Leave Without Pay (LOP).
- Suspension.
- Termination of employment.

The company reserves the right to determine the appropriate disciplinary action based on the circumstances of each case.

26. Medical Emergency

For the purpose of this handbook, a medical emergency includes any sudden illness, accident, injury, or hospitalisation that prevents an employee from informing the company in advance or reporting to work.

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Employees must notify their Reporting Manager and the HR team as soon as reasonably possible and may be required to submit supporting medical documents.

27. Interpretation of Policies

This handbook provides general guidelines governing employment with Germane Media LLC.

Nothing contained in this handbook shall be interpreted as creating a contractual guarantee of employment, promotion, salary revision, incentive, reimbursement, bonus, or any other employment benefit unless specifically provided in the employee's Employment Agreement.

In the event of any conflict between this handbook and the employee's Employment Agreement or applicable law, the Employment Agreement and applicable law shall prevail.

28. Policy Amendments

The company reserves the right to amend, modify, interpret, suspend, replace, or withdraw any policy contained in this handbook, either wholly or partly, at any time without prior notice.

Any changes shall become effective from the date notified by the company through official communication channels.

29. Management's Discretion

Wherever this handbook refers to approvals, benefits, reimbursements, incentives, disciplinary action, leave approvals, promotions, variable pay, transfers, or any employment-related decision, such matters shall remain subject to the sole discretion of the Management, unless otherwise expressly provided in the employee's Employment Agreement or applicable law.

The Management's decision in such matters shall be final.

Employee Acknowledgement

I acknowledge that I have received, read, and understood Germane Media LLC Employee Policy Handbook.

I understand that it is my responsibility to comply with all company policies, procedures, and guidelines contained in this handbook and any future amendments communicated by the company.

I further understand that these policies may be modified, amended, or withdrawn by the company from time to time.

Employee Name	
Signature	
Department	
Date	

